a missile power. Ours is a country with tremendous vitality. Even though the world may not see its ful potential or feel its ful power, no one dare ignore it any more.

On 15 October, I turned sixty. I looked forward to retirement and planned to open a school for the less privileged children. My friend, Prof. P Rama Rao, who was heading the Department of Science and Technology in the Government of India, even struck up a partnership with me to establish what he cal ed the Rao-Kalam school. We were unanimous in our opinion that carrying out certain missions and reaching certain milestones, however important they may be or however impressive they might appear to be, is not al there is to life. But we had to postpone our plan as neither of us was relieved from our post by the Government of India.

It was during this period that I decided to put down my memoirs and express my observations and opinions on certain issues.

The biggest problem Indian youth faced, I felt, was a lack of clarity of vision, a lack of direction. It was then that I decided to write about the circumstances and people who made me what I am today; the idea was not merely to pay